

A Mercurial Almanac for the Year 2027



The Temple of Mercury

Every day of the Calendar, set against the sky of one particular year. The fixed feasts keep their dates; the Mercury cycle and the Moon are given from the ephemeris. Times are Universal Time, so a date near midnight may fall a day earlier where you are. Keep what you will keep.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE



THE FIXED FEASTS

Jan 1 **The Door of the Year** Janus.

Feb 13–22 **The Days of the Dead** Hermanubis, ending at the Caristia.

Mar 20 **The Ascent** Sandalphon. Equinox at 20:25 UT.

Mar 25 **The Announcement** Gabriel and Idris.

Apr 1 **The Trickster's Day** Mercury.

May 15 **The Mercuralia** Mercury. The Day of Accounting.

Jun 9 **The Vestalia** Hestia.

Jun 21 **The Open Gate** Uriel. Solstice at 14:11 UT.

Jul **The Hermaia** Hermes of the gymnasium. Any day; Jul 15 suggested, to fall with his morning elongation.

Aug 29 **The Scribe's New Year** Thermes.

Sep 23 **The Weighing** Ma'at. Equinox at 06:02 UT, so the evening of Sep 22 in the Americas.

Oct 11 **The Meditrinalia** Apharael.

Nov **The Fallow Month** Nothing is asked.

Dec 22 **The Kept Gate** Raziel. Solstice at 02:43 UT, so the night of Dec 21 in the Americas.

Dec 31 **The Closing of the Account** The Ledger's year end.

YOUR MOVING DAYS

Three feasts no almanac can print, because they are yours. Write them in.

_____ **Your Birthday** Metatron and Sandalphon. Write the date here, and see which turn of the wheel it falls in; the sky will have something to say about it.

_____ **The Book's Day** The anniversary of the Dedication.

— **The Good Hour** Declared, not dated. Rosmerta and the Charites. You will know it when it comes.

THE MERCURY CYCLE



Three full turns of the wheel this year, and the tail of a fourth. Each begins high, runs outward as the evening star, turns, descends to the deep heart, turns again, and rises as the morning star. Dates from Fred Espenak's sky almanac, Universal Time.

FIRST TURN

Jan 1 Superior Cazimi The High Heart, at 17h. The year opens at the height of the cycle: Metatron and Sandalphon, and the working that matters most.

Jan–Feb The Evening Star Hermes after sunset. The outward season.

Feb 3 Greatest Elongation 18.3° east. The Scribe's own day; best evening viewing.

Feb 9 Station Retrograde The turn. Stop starting things.

Feb 18 Inferior Cazimi The Deep Heart, at 17h. Hermanubis. The Descent, and the deepest day of the first turn.

Mar 3 Station Direct The second turn, the face looking forward.

Mar 17 Greatest Elongation 27.6° west, and the widest of the year. Morning star; Apharael. The best Setting Out of 2027.

SECOND TURN

Apr 28 Superior Cazimi The High Heart, at 21h.

May 28 Greatest Elongation 22.9° east. Evening star.

Jun 10 Station Retrograde The turn.

Jun 23 Inferior Cazimi The Deep Heart, at 08h, two days after the solstice. Hermanubis.

Jul 4 Station Direct The second turn.

Jul 15 Greatest Elongation 20.7° west. Morning star, and the natural day for the Hermaia.

THIRD TURN

Aug 11 Superior Cazimi The High Heart, at 11h.

Sep 24 Greatest Elongation 26.3° east. Evening star, the day after the Weighing.

Oct 7 Station Retrograde The turn.

Oct 19 Inferior Cazimi The Deep Heart, at 15h. Hermanubis.

Oct 28 Station Direct The second turn.

Nov 4 Greatest Elongation 18.8° west. Morning star, in the Fallow Month;
nothing is asked of it.

FOURTH TURN, BEGINNING

Dec 11 Superior Cazimi The High Heart, at 22h. The last Heart Day of the
year, eleven days before the Kept Gate.

THE MOON



Gabriel's two days, twelve times over: the New Moon to declare and the Full Moon to be seen and to read. The quarters mark the middle of the waxing fortnight, when the bridge is walked, and of the waning one, when accounts are settled. Universal Time; a date near midnight may fall a day earlier where you are.

	New	First Qtr	Full	Last Qtr
Jan	7	15	22	29
Feb	6	14	20	28
Mar	8	15	22	30
Apr	6	13	20	28
May	6	13	20	28
Jun	4	11	19	27
Jul	4	10	18	26
Aug	2, 31	9	17	25
Sep	30	7	15	23
Oct	29	7	15	22
Nov	28	6	14	21
Dec	27	6	13	20

WHERE THE MOON AND MERCURY AGREE

Feb 20 Full Moon in the Days of the Dead, two days after the Deep Heart. The darkest stretch of the year is lit for one night.

Mar 6 The crescent beside Mercury before dawn, an old five-percent moon within three degrees of the morning star, eleven days before his widest elongation. Gabriel and Mercury in one glance; go out and look.

Mar 22 Full Moon two days after the Ascent and five after the widest morning star. The spring beginning is seen quickly.

Jul 4 New Moon on the day of Station Direct. The cleanest beginning of the year: cast here if you cast once.

Aug 2 New Moon, and a total eclipse of the Sun whose path crosses Egypt, with more than six minutes of totality over Luxor, ancient Thebes. The Sun's own Deep Heart, over Thoth's country, nine days before the High Heart. Where you are it may be partial or nothing; keep the day quiet anyway.

Sep 23 Last Quarter on the Weighing, the day the scales stand level. Release at the scale.

Oct 1 The crescent beside Mercury after sunset, a young three-percent moon within two degrees of the evening star, a week after his elongation.

Oct 7 First Quarter on Station Retrograde: the turn comes with the moon half-built. A caution against starting.

Dec 13 Full Moon two days after the last High Heart. The year's final declaration, fully lit.

THE RECURRING RHYTHM



EVERY WEDNESDAY. Mercury's day. The full Door. Fifty-two of them: the year is mostly this.

THE FIRST OF EACH MONTH. Janus. Reread the month behind you.

THE FOURTH. Mercury's birthday, twelve times over. A story told, a gift with no occasion.

THE SEVENTH. Apharael. The measure day.

THE SWEEP. Once a month, on the first, with Janus.

THE NEW AND FULL MOONS. Gabriel's two days. The dates are on the page before this one.

WHAT THE YEAR IS SHAPED LIKE

2027 is a year with a heavy spring. Three of the four Heart Days fall before September, and the widest morning star of the year comes on March 17, three days before the Ascent. If there is a journey, a move, or a recovery to begin, the sky is arguing for the second half of March.

Mercury enters the retrograde shadow on January 25, and the first turn's Deep Heart lands three weeks later on February 18. If one of your Moving Days falls in that stretch, the year has handed you the looking-back season as a gift; take it.

The dark stretch is February. The Days of the Dead run the 13th to the 22nd, and the Deep Heart falls on the 18th, inside them. Those ten days are the deepest of 2027 and they were not arranged; Parentalia is fixed and the cazimi is astronomy. Keep the Descent there if you keep it anywhere.

The thin stretch is November. One elongation, no feast, and the Fallow Month laid over it. That is the year's rest, and it is deliberate.

The one day to cast, if there is one, is July 4: a New Moon on the day Mercury turns direct, with the morning star eleven days off. The sky will not line up like that again this year.

IF YOU KEEP ONLY FIVE DAYS

January 1, the Door of the Year. February 18, the Deep Heart. March 17, the morning star, for whatever you are beginning. May 15, the Mercuralia. December 31, the Closing of the Account. Everything else is resolution.



A calendar nobody observes is a reproach, and this Temple has no use for reproach.